



2 **MUKESH AMBANI**

50, INDUSTRIALIST (2)

THE MULTIPLIER

BECAUSE he has turned Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL) into a money machine. Because his businesses will generate over Rs 60,000 crore in cash reserves every year by the end of 2008, twice the total dividend received from PSUs this year. Because he can work political connections to his advantage, whether it is handling opposition to his retail plans or heading off a confrontation with his brother on gas pricing. Because he has doubled his group's market cap from just over \$53 billion to \$106 billion in the last one year. Because he has taken the group's turnover from \$27 billion to \$34 billion. Because his wealth makes him one of the richest people in the world. Because Reliance will be among the biggest private gas producers in the country with over 12 trillion cubic ft of reserves by 2009. Because his new businesses will create enough cash to make him the most cash-rich businessman by 2012, with over \$66 billion to spare. Because he and friend Anand Jain are setting up four SEZs.

LOOKING FORWARD

TO: Antilia, his Rs 600-crore, 60-storeyed new home on Altamont Rd.

LITTLE KNOWN

FACT: His wife Nita gifted him a cottage at Tirupati on his 50th birthday.

HIS IDEA OF WINDING DOWN:

Spending quality time with his children, teaching his younger son Anant, 13, maths and helping daughter Isha, 16, with

her SAT preparations.

NEXT BIG THING:

The rural push, where he will deploy credit and technology to improve earnings.

RETAIL MANTRA: "We have gone from zero to 500, that is 500X. From here on, 5,000 shops is only 10 times more."

PERSONAL FLEET: Of six aircraft includes an Airbus Corporate Jet and a Global Express XRS.

HIS ABILITY TO CREATE WEALTH FOR HIMSELF AND ALSO THOUSANDS OF SHAREHOLDERS HAS EARNED HIM A CULT FOLLOWING.

BANDEEP SINGH